Ysbyty Gwynedd
Emergency Laparotomy Pathway

*This pathway is intended for all patients presenting with acute abdominal pain that may require emergency laparotomy**

[1]SEPSIS 6
Supplemental Oxygen
Lactate
Blood Cultures
IV Fluid resuscitation
IV Antibiotics
Urinary Catheter

Emergency Assessment
- NEWS score within 30 minutes of admission
- FBC/U+E/LFT/CRP/Clotting/Amylase/G+S
- Lactate
- Identification & implementation of Sepsis 6[1]
- Antibiotics given within 1 hour of sepsis diagnosis
- Frailty Assessment

* excluding suspected isolated appendix & gall bladder or renal pathology

[2]ESCALATION CRITERIA
Any of:
NEWS >6
Lactate >4
Pneumoperitoneum on CXR
Suspected Peritonitis
Refractory Abdominal Pain
Non-Specific concern for patient

Escalation Criteria[2]

Absent

Surgical Middle Grade Review within 2hrs of admission/referral

Assessment by Consultant within 14 hrs

CT Scan within 12 hrs of initial surgical review

Detailed completion of CT request form is mandatory

Present

Surgical Middle Grade Review within ½ hr of admission/referral

Inform Consultant Surgeon immediately

Urgent CT Scan:
Direct Senior Discussion with Radiologist

Patient too unwell to wait for CT scan

CT Report Review
If Intra-abdominal sepsis: Verbal report to Consultant Surgeon

RISK ASSESSMENT: Document in Notes

High Risk Indicators
- Escalation criteria present
- NELA Risk Score ≥5%
- ASA ≥3
- Insulin Dependant Diabetes
- CKD eGFR ≤45
- Acute Kidney Injury
- Age ≥70
- Clinical Frailty Score ≥4
- Immunosuppressive therapy

Mortality Risk: Low <5%

Mortality Risk: High 5-9%
- 063 Anaesthetist to request Pre-Op review by Consultant Anaesthetist

Mortality Risk: High ≥10%
- Pre-Op review by Consultant Anaesthetist
- Consultant Surgeon to directly contact Consultant Anaesthetist

Decision made for Emergency Laparotomy
Booking: Use NELA Urgency criteria: 1 < 2hrs, 2A 2-6hrs, 2B 6-18hrs, 3 >18hrs

Direct Consultant Anaesthetist & Surgeon Intra-Operative Care

Mortality Risk: High ≥25%
MDT Discuss with patient/family palliation as an alternative to surgery

Palliative Care: For advice
09:00-17:00: Bleep 183
Out of hours Advice line: 01978 316800

POST OPERATIVE CARE

At Operation End:
Re-calculate Mortality Risk using the surgical findings

WARD

Critical Care

- Physiotherapy within 24 hours
- Refer for Care of The Elderly Team Review if:
  ≥80 yrs old & Clinical Frailty Score (Rockwood) ≥6